

Day 7 — Discussion: Should IKS Be in Science Class?

Module: Pañcabhūta (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students articulate and defend a position on whether classical Indian intellectual frameworks should be taught in mainstream science class, with at least one citation and one steel-manned counter-argument.

Materials

- Whiteboard
- Stopwatch
- Score sheet for the oral assessment (rubric below)

Flow

Warm-up (3 min)

- Brief: today is structured debate. Three positions on the table. Pick one. Defend it. Acknowledge the other two fairly.

The three positions (5 min — clarify, don't argue yet)

Write on board:

Position	One-line claim
A — Integration	IKS frameworks should be taught alongside modern science in mainstream science class.
B — Separation	IKS should be taught in cultural studies or philosophy, not in science class.
C — Hybrid	IKS should be referenced briefly in science class as historical context, but not taught as parallel content.

Debate (25 min)

- Divide class into 3 groups by position (let students self-select; balance roughly).
- 5 min: each group prepares — strongest 2 arguments, 1 steel-manned response to the other two positions.
- 12 min: structured debate. Each group has 4 min.
 - 2 min: main argument.
 - 1 min: response to the other 2 positions.
 - 1 min: closing.
- 8 min: open floor cross-questions.

Oral assessment (during the debate)

Teacher uses this rubric to score 5 students chosen at random:

Criterion	4	3	2	1
Position clarity	Crystal clear with 1-line summary	Clear	Mostly clear	Unclear
Use of evidence	Cites at least 1 specific source	Cites generally	Vague references	No evidence
Counter-argument	Steel-mans an opposing view	Acknowledges another view	Mentions another view	Ignores
Listening	Responds to specific points raised	Responds generally	Sticks to script	Doesn't engage

Wrap-up (10 min)

- Take 3 student reflections: *“Did anyone’s mind change during the debate?”*
- Note: the goal is not to “win” but to *understand the strongest version of each position*.
- Preview Day 8: *“Tomorrow you start your paper. Use this debate to sharpen your own thesis.”*

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Take a position you DISAGREE with and defend it. (The hardest form of argument.)
- **Tier down:** Pre-prepare your 2-minute argument the night before.

Teacher notes

- This is where some students discover they don’t really know what they think. That’s the point.
- If the debate gets heated, slow it down: *“Steel-man the other side. What’s their best argument?”*
- The Day 7 oral grade flows into the project rubric — not as a separate score.

Citation(s) used

- All sources from `sources.md` are fair game during the debate.